

Alaska Cruise Cheat Sheet (May–September)

The month table, the layering system, formal night, and the bag-size math — one page to pack against.

WEATHER BY MONTH — INSIDE PASSAGE TYPICAL RANGES

MONTH	CONDITIONS	WHAT CHANGES
May	40–55°F, frequent rain + wind	Thermals 2–3, insulated fleece, waterproof shell
June	50–65°F, long daylight, variable	Fleece mid layer, packable rain shell
July	55–68°F, warmest month	Thin fleece, rain shell, sunscreen + sunglasses
August	48–62°F, increasing rain	Fleece, waterproof shell, beanie
September	42–55°F, most sustained rain	Thermals 2–3, insulated fleece, waterproof shell

THE CORE LIST (EVERY MONTH)

Moisture-wicking tops	4–6 (long-sleeve leaning in May/Sept)
Travel pants	2–3 (add shorts in July)
Fleece mid layer	1 (insulated weight in May/Sept)
Waterproof rain shell with hood	1 — non-negotiable, every month
Underwear & socks	5–7 pairs
Walking shoes	worn, not packed
Warm accessories	beanie + gloves (shoulder months)
Binoculars + power bank	glacier days are long days

FORMAL NIGHT & THE BAG-SIZE MATH

- Formal night: 1–2 dinner outfits cover a 7-night sailing; dedicated dress shoes usually push you to a checked bag.
- Light / efficient layering: 35–40L · Most Alaska cruises: 40–50L · Bulky outerwear or camera gear: 50L+
- Glacier-day rule: near the ice it runs 10–15°F colder than port — pack the warm layer even in July.